



TermiSoc's Security Policy

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TermiSoc Security Policy

Abstract

This document defines TermiSoc's security policy. It covers issues such as access to administrative rights on the all of TermiSoc's servers, kernel and package updates, user accounts, the services provided by the servers as well as disciplinary action to be taken by the committee when any of these guidelines are broken.

1. Introduction

This is Version 1.51 of TermiSoc's Security Policy and was originally authored by Ryan Smith, with minor updates by Richard Jeffery.

1.1 Terminology

The words "require" and "must" indicate mandatory policy, which MUST BE ADHERED TO.

The word "recommend" indicates that TermiSoc offers a suggestion to its members but does not yet enforce the rule as mandatory.

"Committee" refers to the central administration of TermiSoc, TermiSoc's servers and TermiSoc's services. At the time of writing such committee included:

- President
- Secretary
- Treasurer
- Safety Officer
- Head Technical Officer

"Sub-committees" refers to teams working under the Committee and are subject to change. At the time of writing the sub-committees are:

- Social and Public Relations
- Technical

1.2 Maintenance of the Security Policy

TermiSoc's security policy is to be maintained by the Head Technical Officer and Assistant Technical Officer.

It is each system user's responsibility to be aware of the security policy and to act in accordance with it.

TermiSoc's Security Policy will be updated as necessary to reflect changes in the university-wide security policy.

Computing Services are to be made aware of any changes made to TermiSoc's Security Policy.

1.3 TermiSoc's Servers

As part of its service to its members, TermiSoc runs the following servers:

Name	IP	Operating System	Purpose
Apple	141.163.153.1	Fedora Core 2, kernel 2.6.8	TermiSoc's main server, providing mail and HTTP services. All members of TermiSoc are entitled to an account on Apple.
Orange	141.163.153.2	Debian, kernel 2.6	TermiSoc's project machine. Provides members with a Linux server for execution and implementation of projects. Also, TermiSoc's secondary nameserver.
Banana	141.163.153.3	Debian, kernel 2.6	TermiSoc's primary nameserver. Banana is only to be used for DNS. ¹

¹

2. Administration

2.1 Physical Access

Computing Services maintain a list of Trusted Members who have physical access to TermiSoc's servers. Typically this list includes:

- Head Technical Officer
- Assistant Technical Officer
- President

No other person is authorised to gain physical access to TermiSoc's servers.

2.2 Root Access

Root access is available only through execution of the 'su' command from a shell account. No direct access to root is available via either ssh, telnet or any other service provided by any of TermiSoc's servers.

Root access is only available to the following members of the Committee:

Server	Root Access
Apple	Head Technical Officer, President
Orange	Head Technical Officer, Assistant Technical Officer, President,
Banana	Head Technical Officer, President
Esra	Head Technical Officer, President

2.3 Root Passwords

Root passwords on all of TermiSoc's servers **MUST**:

- be at least 10 characters in length
- include variations in case
- include symbols and/or numerical characters

2.4 Website Administration

All Web files, (located in /var/www/) belong to the 'web' usergroup. Only members of the TermiSoc committee or sub-committees who are members on this usergroup have access to those files via the shell.

The members of the 'web' group are:

- Head Technical Officer
- Assistant Technical Officer
- President
- Secretary
- Webmaster (if different from the above)

2.5 MySQL Administration

TermiSoc provides a MySQL to support its own Web services and other activities. TermiSoc's own databases are administered by:

- Head Technical Officer
- Assistant Technical Officer

On a day-to-day basis databases are to be administered by the Assistant Technical Officer. Where extensive maintenance is required, the ATO may call upon the HTO.

TermiSoc provides a mailing list service, both for its members and for communication with its members.

2.6 Administration of all Mailing Lists

Administration of mailing lists provided by TermiSoc is the responsibility of TermiSoc's Head Technical Officer and Assistant Technical Officer.

3. Software

TermiSoc and its members **MUST** abide by the follow guidelines in reference to software used on TermiSoc's servers.

3.1 Kernel Updates

Updates to the kernel are checked for on a weekly basis and installed as needed.

3.2 Package Updates

Updates to packages are checked for on a weekly basis and installed as needed.

3.3 Software Licensing

TermiSoc and its members **MUST** use only software it is entitled to use under the terms and conditions of the software licenses as well as law.

4. User Accounts

4.1 Guidelines for Users

4.1.1 Use of Shell Accounts

Users on accounts on any of TermiSoc's servers **MUST** adhere to the following guidelines.

User accounts on any of TermiSoc machines are intended **ONLY** for the purpose for which they were created. As soon as an account is no longer necessary, the owner of the account **MUST** inform the committee immediately.

Each user account is intended **ONLY** for the use of the owner of that account. Allowing unauthorised access to user accounts, by whatever means, is strictly prohibited.

4.1.2 Password Policy: User Guidelines

Users are **required** to maintain a secure password, which **MUST**:

- be at least 8 characters in length
- **NOT** be a dictionary word, in any language
- **NOT** be the same as the username

It is **recommended** that user account passwords:

- be at least 10 characters long
- include variations in case
- include symbols and/or numerical characters

4.2 Administration of User Accounts

4.2.1 Account Creation

Any member of the Committee or sub-committees (with root access) may create user accounts, however, all guidelines regarding the creation of new accounts, as laid down in the Constitution, **MUST** be followed.

4.2.2 Security Enforcement

The Head Technical Officer is required to execute 'password cracking' software on a monthly basis. Any accounts found to have an insecure password **MUST** be disabled immediately. Reactivation of accounts disabled in this way is only possible during a personal meeting between the owner of the account and the Head technical Officer. The HTO is required to take whatever action is deemed necessary to ensure the user selects a secure password.

4.2.3 Password Policy: System Rules

Passwords for user accounts **MUST** be changed AT LEAST every month. Users **MUST NOT** re-use old passwords when this change is required. Users are required to keep the new password for AT LEAST one week before it may be changed.

5. Services

5.1 Current Services

TermiSoc uses its servers to provide the following services to its members:

Service	Machines	Port
FTP	Apple, Orange	21
SCP	Apple, Orange	22
SSH	Apple, Orange, Banana	22
HTTP	Apple	80
POP3	Apple	110
SMTP	Apple	25
DNS ²	Banana, Orange	53
TIME ³	Orange	7890
Telnet	Apple	23

5.2 Changes to Services

Changes to these services can only be implemented by the submission of a formal request to TermiSoc's Committee. This must take the form:

² TermiSoc maintains Banana as its primary DNS and Orange as its seconday DNS

³ TermiSoc's Integrated Meeting Environment, currently a project for Second Year undergraduate students on BSc(Hons) Computing and is intended to form part of TermiSoc's services during this academic year

- Statement of the service
- Purpose the service will fulfil
- Which machine the service is requested on

After consideration by the Committee, any successful applications will be forwarded to Computing Services. Implementation of all service on TermiSoc's machine is at the full discretion of Computing Services.

6. Disciplinary Action

Contravention of any part of this document will result in disciplinary action. Such action may include:

- Loss of root access (where applicable)
- Loss of all admin privileges (where applicable), including but not limited to
 - MySQL administration
 - Web services administration
- Suspension of any accounts held on TermiSoc's servers pending investigation
- Termination of membership to the society without refund, leading to
 - Possible Union disciplinary action
 - Loss of access to TermiSoc's servers
 - Loss of all privileges of membership
- Any other steps TermiSoc's Committee feel are necessary to enforce a ruling

Disciplinary action will be taken for any action considered by TermiSoc's Committee to be a threat to the security of TermiSoc's servers, the security of University computer systems, any third party computer systems or the well being of any individual, where TermiSoc property has been used to wilfully inflict harm or cause damage. Such offences include but are not limited to:

- User account being used maliciously, with or without the consent of the account owner
- Not taking appropriate action upon being informed of, or otherwise becoming aware of, a security issue
- Providing non-members of TermiSoc with access to TermiSoc's property, excepting HTTP access to Web files on port 80 of Apple (141.163.153.1)
- Providing access to a shell account to anyone other than the owner of that shell account
- Running or otherwise storing cracked, pirated or otherwise illegal software or data on TermiSoc's servers
- Using TermiSoc's servers for any purpose other than that stated in TermiSoc's documentation